

Stability

What good would software be if it crashes when you push a button on its window? If it's not stable enough to make you run the virtual machines the way you want it to, by all means avoid it and go for another version of the same software or another software altogether. Let's say you're running a Linux system and a virtual machine crashes when you try to take snapshots in VirtualBox (a famous virtualization software). In such cases it's better to install KVM/Qemu than try to destroy things by running VirtualBox. Of course, we're not saying by any means that VirtualBox is bad software. This is just an example and Qemu could crash too. It's simply a matter of selecting a stable software.

Speaking of stability and VirtualBox in the same line, there's something you should know. VirtualBox can throw up quite a few errors just because you didn't install and configure it properly. This can happen with other software as well, but VirtualBox does this a lot more than others. Having incorrectly configured software is different than having an unstable one. Software that's not configured well will most likely give problems before you start running a virtual machine on it; whereas unstable software would crash and close itself after you've started working. So be prudent and scour the net for reviews before you start thinking that the software you're trying to use is an unstable one. Finding such things beforehand always helps.

Lower resource usage

Remember Windows Vista being a pathetic memory hog and the complaints that were shot at Microsoft for releasing it premature? Compare it to Windows 7. What was different if you look at the features? Hardly anything, but Windows 7 consumes a whole lot less memory and processor power than Vista did. Virtualization software consuming more memory would leave lesser headroom for the actual virtual machine you want to run. If you don't have too much RAM and one hell of a powerful processor on your system, it won't matter. The extra resource usage by the virtualization software will leave a lot lesser room for the actual virtual machine and things will begin to get slow!

Because we used Windows 7 and Windows Vista as examples, it doesn't mean that you have to wait for two years if the software you're trying to use consumes more memory than what you'd like it to. It's just that you should pick up the one which does the jobs you want it to and keeps it easy on your system.